welcome

Mitchell Gordon & Daniel Jackson

who we are


Mitchell Gordon (Lec)


Daniel Jackson (Lec)


Eagon Meng (GTA)


Carmel Schare (GTA)


Kartik Pingle (GTA)


Arielle Blattner (Lec)

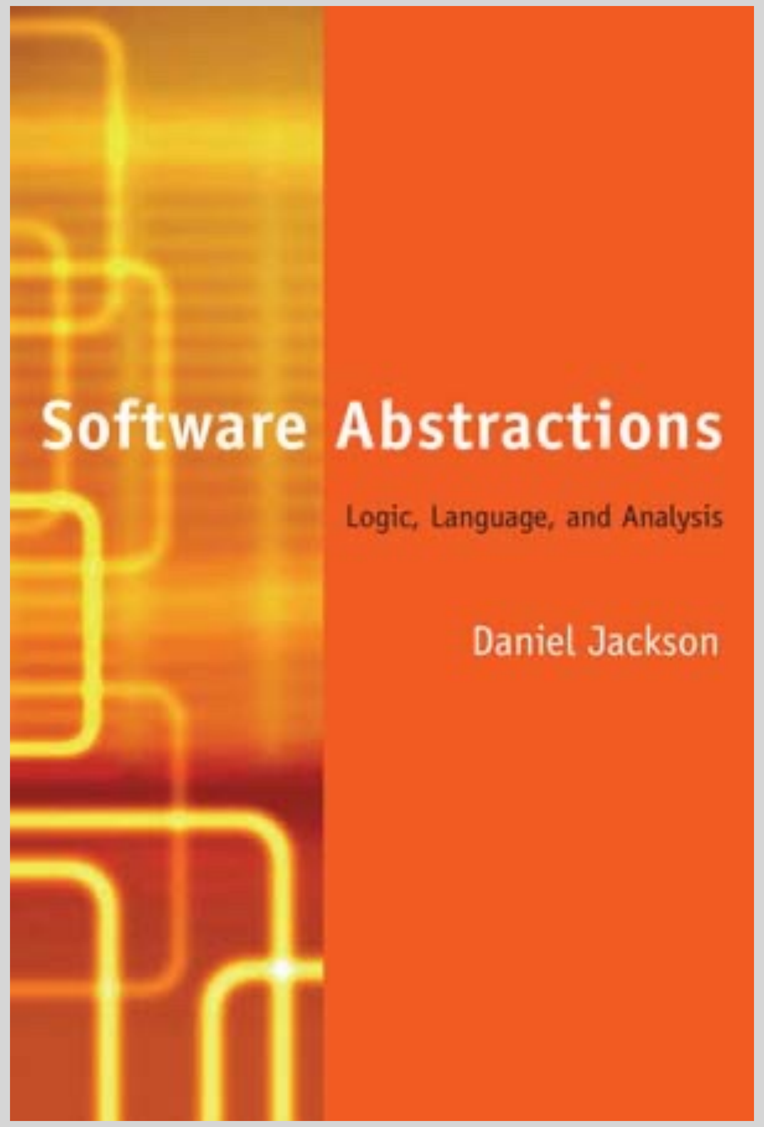

Amalia Toutziaridi (UTA)


Christine Wu (UTA)

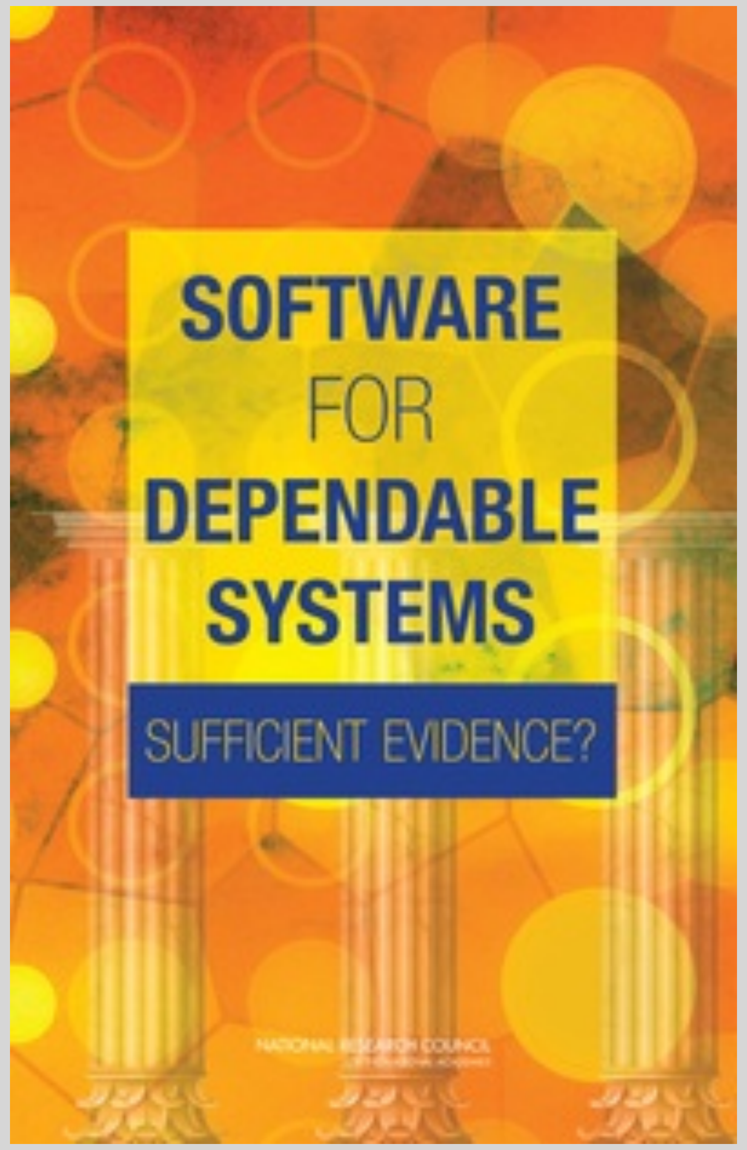

Barish Namazov (tech)

about me

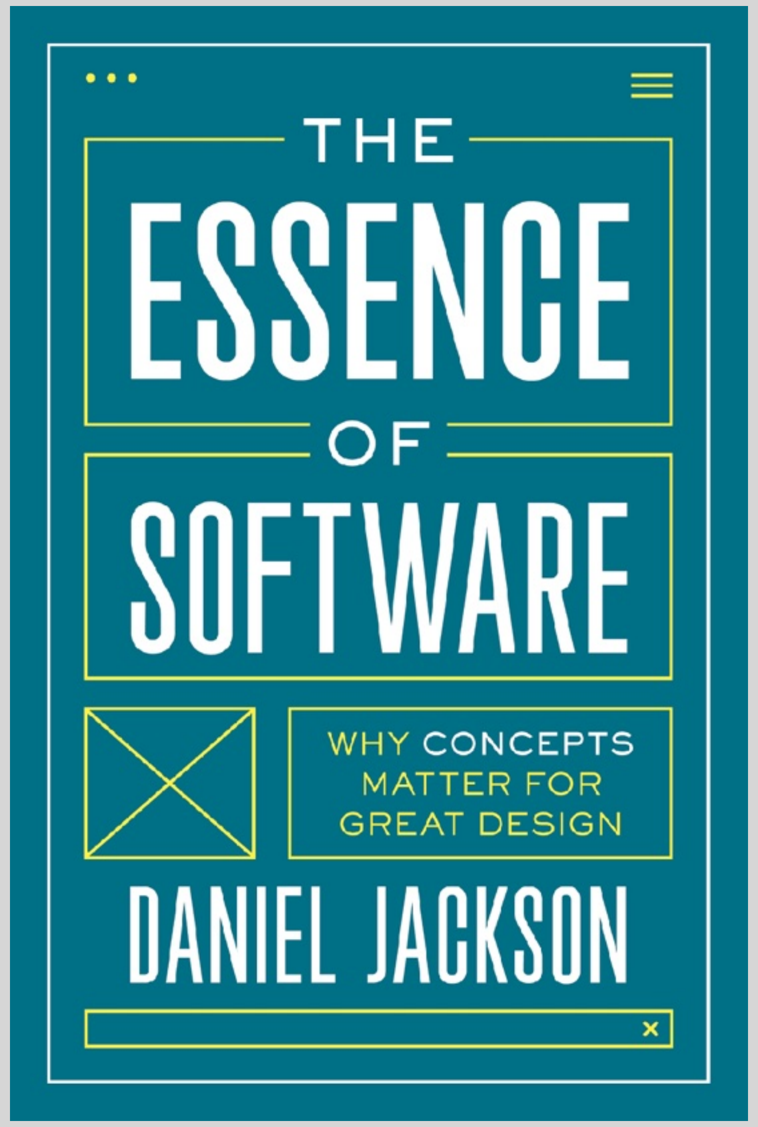
my research interests



Alloy, a modeling tool
mechanizing analysis of software designs



dependable systems
ensuring catastrophes don't happen



concept design
how to think about software

when I'm not working

how about you?

what do you hope to get out of this class?

9THJXK

https://class.mit-sdg.dev/join

about the class

what this class is

a design class
design and build apps
using AI in a principled way

what this class isn't

a webdev class
about platforms
and all their details

a vibe coding class
code that "mostly works"
without understanding it

a UI class
about user interfaces
and visual design

an HCI class
about social &
psychological factors

this class has 2 premises

design is learnable

not a skill people are born with

comes with practice & reflection

AI changes everything

design now matters more than ever

building is easier, so design can be more ambitious

Many Computer Science (CS) programs still center around problems that AI can now solve competently. **The future belongs to developers who can model systems, anticipate edge cases, and translate ambiguity into structure—skills that AI can't automate.** We need to teach abstraction, decomposition, and specification not just as pre-coding steps, but as the new coding.

Thomas Dohmke, GitHub CEO

what's new (and isn't) in 6.104

like last year

focus on designing functionality
shaping functionality with concepts
(un)intended consequences

learning by doing on real projects
designing and building an app (2x)
working in a team (for second project)
choose your own problem

integrating LLMs
for coding and more
as app components

new this term

much improved platform
works with any coding harness
simpler structure, more reliable

more on user experience (UX)
how to conduct user testing
more on usability/ethics and AI

empowering student agency
less prescriptive assignments
skill-based rubrics
competency grading

https://aiandeducation.mit.edu/

this week's activities

complete prep (by recitation tomorrow)
setting up your GitHub repo and playing with markdown to be ready for recitation

attend recitation (tomorrow)
pick the time you prefer, can change later

join the class forum (tomorrow)
you'll get an email from us with a link

read the class guide (this weekend)
so you know how this class works and *why*

problem framing assignment (by midnight Monday)
get going early so you have time to mull it over

http://web.mit.edu/6.104

a word of advice

use this opportunity well

as a chance to learn

for yourself, not your grade*